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Micro Certificate Program Syllabus

Strategic AI Leadership in Business

Learning How to Power Strategy, Execution and Impact with AI

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Certificate Program Information

The Strategic AI Leadership in Business Micro Certificate Program focuses on preparing business leaders, managers and emerging AI champions to lead organizational transformation through the strategic application of AI. This five-week intensive experience builds the leadership mindset, operational fluency and capability-driven frameworks required to integrate AI into business strategy, execution and enterprise innovation.

Throughout the program, students will explore how AI can unlock competitive advantage, reshape the workplace ecosystem and redefine leadership at every level of the organization. They will learn how to translate high-level AI strategy into scalable implementation, drive cross-functional integration and measure the value of AI through budgeting, ROI analysis and operational gains. Students will also examine the foundations of AI readiness, including technical capability, cultural alignment and collaborative influence, especially when formal authority is limited.

As the program progresses, students will deepen their understanding of responsible AI governance and risk management, learning to design ethical guardrails and compliance frameworks that enable trust and innovation at scale. The final class centers on harnessing AI for enterprise-wide transformation, using it to reimagine services, products, systems and strategies that position organizations for long-term success.

The learning experience combines strategic frameworks, applied analysis and simulation-based thinking. Students will engage in real-time use case modeling, build personalized leadership roadmaps and gain hands-on exposure to the tools, language and disciplines required to lead AI-powered change.

By the end of the program, students will be equipped not only to understand AI but to lead with it, building influence, shaping adoption and helping their organizations turn AI from a trend into a core business capability.

Certificate Program Guidelines

The [Certificate Program Guidelines] document is designed to provide you with all the necessary information to maximize your participation in the program. From general rules to detailed descriptions of class schedules, post-class activities, assessment criteria, and beyond, these guidelines serve as your go-to resource for understanding the program's structure, expectations, and the wealth of opportunities it offers for professional and personal growth.

Who should take this program?

This Micro Certificate Program is designed for professionals across industries who are ready to lead in AI-powered organizations. It is especially relevant for managers, team leaders and rising executives in roles related to business strategy, operations, innovation, HR, transformation or communications. Whether you are already experimenting with AI or just beginning to explore its potential, this program will help you move from understanding AI to applying it as a core capability in your work. No technical background is required, only a strategic mindset and a commitment to preparing your organization and career for the next era of business leadership.

Functional Areas and Competency Framework

We provide a structured and comprehensive competency framework as part of this certificate program.

Functional Area No. 1 (Class 1). Strategic Leadership in the Age of AI: Unlocking Business Competitive Advantage with AI-Powered Human Intelligence

In this class, students will explore how AI is reshaping the foundations of business strategy, leadership and value creation. They will learn how to think beyond tools and trends and begin to see AI as a force that redefines competition, performance and the role of human intelligence in organizations.

The class focuses on helping students understand AI not as a technology to manage but as a capability to lead. They will examine the new mental models required to navigate AI-powered change and begin mapping how their own leadership approach must evolve. Through real-world cases, critical frameworks and collaborative reflection, students will develop the foundational mindset and strategic lens needed to lead in AI-augmented environments.

Learning Objectives:

1. Analyze how AI changes the strategic foundations of competitive advantage across industries
2. Identify new leadership imperatives created by AI augmentation at scale
3. Evaluate the role of human intelligence in decision-making, design and organizational performance
4. Develop an executive perspective on where, how and why AI generates differentiated business value

Competencies:

1. Frame AI as a business capability that drives advantage as a core augmentative capability integrated across all components of the workplace ecosystem
2. Analyze AI's impact on strategic positioning, resource allocation and performance metrics

3. Translate emerging AI shifts into implications for leadership priorities and business models
4. Distinguish between tool usage and capability development in the context of strategy
5. Engage in strategic conversations about AI adoption, investment and leadership development

Guiding Questions:

1. How does AI reshape the building blocks of business competitive advantage?
2. What new capabilities must leaders develop to stay relevant and effective in the age of AI?
3. Where is human intelligence still essential and how can it be amplified by AI systems?
4. What are the risks of treating AI as just a tool rather than a business enabler?
5. How do AI-driven shifts in productivity, insight and automation change the nature of leadership?
6. How should business leaders evaluate AI investments relative to talent, culture... and long-term growth?
7. What distinguishes organizations that are simply using AI from those that are winning with it?
8. What frameworks can help leaders align AI potential with business strategy?
9. What questions should leaders ask when considering how AI will impact their own roles and responsibilities?
10. How can strategic leaders ensure that AI strengthens the value of human judgment and amplifies human intelligence?
11. What are the hidden costs of ignoring or underestimating AI's impact on strategy and operations?
12. How can leaders create a culture that supports strategic AI experimentation without chaos?

Functional Area No. 2 (Class 2). Translating AI Strategy into Execution and Workplace Ecosystem Redesign: Cross-Functional Integration at Scale

In this class, participants will learn how to turn high-level AI strategy into cross-functional execution and operational value. They will examine how to integrate AI not as an isolated tool but as a core capability within workflows, systems and workplace ecosystems (Workplace ecosystem: work (the nature of work), workforce (people), how work gets done (culture), data (the raw material), processes, governance, systems and technology).

The class focuses on helping participants identify integration opportunities and navigate the organizational structures, behaviors and decision dynamics that can accelerate or block AI-enabled change. Participants will also explore how to calculate budget needs, forecast ROI and communicate projected gains in ways that resonate with business stakeholders and support enterprise adoption. Through practical frameworks, comparative analysis and cross-functional integration models, participants will begin to build the thinking, fluency and discipline required to lead AI implementation at scale.

Learning Objectives:

1. Translate AI strategy into scalable execution plans across workflows, departments and business units
2. Identify integration opportunities that generate quick wins and long-term advantage
3. Navigate cross-functional collaboration, adoption challenges and execution risks
4. Evaluate how to budget for AI initiatives, estimate ROI and communicate business value

Competencies:

1. Design integration strategies that align with the business model and operational needs
2. Identify low-hanging fruit for AI integration across different functions and teams
3. Communicate AI benefits and risks across departments and stakeholder groups
4. Evaluate cost-benefit tradeoffs of AI adoption including budget forecasting and ROI modeling
5. Collaborate across disciplines to redesign systems, processes and work structures

Guiding Questions:

1. What are the most effective ways to move from AI ambition to enterprise execution?
2. How can we embed AI into workflows without reinforcing outdated processes?
3. What are the early signs that a team, workflow or department is ready for AI integration?
4. What lessons can we learn from failed or stalled AI initiatives across industries?
5. How do we define and measure success in early-stage AI implementation?
6. What role does cross-functional communication play in successful AI execution?
7. How do we calculate the budget, forecast ROI and communicate gains for AI projects?
8. How can we frame integration initiatives as business value drivers?
9. What frameworks help identify and prioritize integration opportunities across the workplace ecosystem?
10. What types of change management challenges arise when embedding AI into operations?
11. How do we ensure AI integration reinforces strategic goals rather than short-term optimization?
12. What governance or oversight is needed to track execution quality and long-term outcomes?

Functional Area No. 3 (Class 3). Developing Organizational AI Readiness Through AI Fluency, Technical Capability, Culture and Collaboration

In this class, students will explore what it takes to build a truly AI-ready organization. They will examine the critical connection between technical capability, cultural readiness and cross-functional collaboration and how these factors shape whether AI initiatives succeed or stall.

The class focuses on helping students identify where capability gaps exist in their teams, departments and companies and how to close them. They will assess readiness across multiple dimensions including infrastructure, data maturity, workforce skills and leadership mindsets. Students will also explore how to build influence and momentum when formal authority is limited and how to structure internal development programs that activate readiness across the business. Through capability assessments, peer learning and strategic mapping, students will gain a structured approach to AI readiness that is grounded in real-world dynamics and forward-looking leadership.

Learning Objectives:

1. Assess organizational readiness for AI adoption across technical, human and cultural dimensions
2. Identify barriers to readiness and design strategies to close capability and adoption gaps
3. Understand the role of fluency and literacy in scaling responsible AI use
4. Build influence and cross-functional momentum for readiness initiatives without formal authority

Competencies:

1. Evaluate workforce and organizational AI fluency and maturity across roles and functions
2. Identify the technical, cultural and behavioral enablers and blockers of AI readiness
3. Develop capability-building strategies tailored to the specific needs of different stakeholder groups
4. Create development programs that improve fluency, trust and responsible AI engagement
5. Collaborate with technical and non-technical teams to align capability with integration goals

Guiding Questions:

1. What does it mean for an organization to be AI-ready and how do we know when we are?
2. What are the most common capability gaps that prevent successful AI adoption?
3. How do we define AI fluency and build it across different levels and roles?
4. What internal resistances tend to emerge when scaling AI and how can they be addressed?
5. How can students drive readiness without formal authority over systems or teams?
6. What are the risks of skipping fluency-building in the rush to integrate AI?
7. How do culture, values and communication styles impact AI readiness?
8. What kinds of training, tools and frameworks best support capability development?
9. How can readiness be measured over time and tied to business outcomes?
10. What approaches work to gain buy-in from skeptical or overextended teams?
11. How do we embed fluency and technical capacity into the organizational learning strategy?
12. What are the hidden costs of readiness gaps in terms of trust, adoption and impact?

Functional Area No. 4 (Class 4). Establishing Ethical, Data Privacy, Accountable and Compliant AI Governance Frameworks

In this class, students will explore how to build strong governance structures that ensure AI is implemented ethically, transparently and in alignment with organizational and regulatory expectations. They will examine what it means to move from principles to practice and how to operationalize AI ethics, data privacy and risk mitigation inside real workplace systems.

The class focuses on helping students understand governance not as a barrier to innovation but as a foundation for responsible deployment and long-term trust. They will assess how to manage risks such as bias, opacity and over-reliance and how to design guardrails that allow for both experimentation and oversight. Through risk models, audit frameworks and practical checklists, students will learn how to lead or support governance efforts that balance innovation and accountability.

Learning Objectives:

1. Examine the foundations of responsible AI use including ethics, fairness and transparency
2. Evaluate governance frameworks for managing AI risks and decision oversight
3. Design practical mechanisms to address data privacy, bias and compliance obligations
4. Develop the ability to align AI governance with organizational values and business strategy

Competencies:

1. Identify the major risks and ethical challenges associated with AI adoption
2. Assess current governance maturity across different departments and systems
3. Develop and apply practical tools for AI oversight, auditing and accountability
4. Align AI decision-making processes with legal, ethical and business standards
5. Contribute to cross-functional governance conversations as a strategic advisor or team member

Guiding Questions:

1. What does responsible AI use look like in practice and how do we measure it?
2. How do we move beyond high-level principles into real governance structures and actions?
3. What risks emerge when AI is deployed without clear oversight or accountability?
4. How can students help their organizations balance innovation and ethical use?
5. What are the most common failures in AI risk management and how can they be avoided?
6. How do we ensure compliance with data privacy regulations while still enabling AI experimentation?
7. What frameworks exist for auditing AI tools and outputs and how do we apply them?
8. How do we define fairness in AI systems and who decides what fair means?
9. How do we communicate governance priorities across teams that see ethics as an afterthought?
10. What are the unintended consequences of ignoring governance at the start of AI adoption?
11. How do organizations manage responsibility when AI makes or influences high-stakes decisions?
12. What does it mean to embed ethical judgment and accountability into the culture of AI use?

Functional Area No. 5 (Class 5). Harnessing AI for Enterprise-Wide Innovation and Strategic Transformation

In this class, students will examine how AI can be used to reimagine entire systems, services and strategies. They will explore how to lead innovation efforts that are grounded in business outcomes and how to apply AI to unlock new forms of value creation, differentiation and strategic evolution.

The class focuses on helping students understand AI as a catalyst for transformation. They will learn how to identify innovation opportunities across products, processes and experiences and how to lead experimental, iterative and cross-functional initiatives that scale. Through frameworks, case examples and guided analysis, students will begin to develop the mindset and methods required to lead AI-fueled transformation responsibly and effectively.

Learning Objectives:

1. Identify strategic opportunities to use AI for innovation beyond efficiency and automation
2. Explore methods to design and scale AI-driven transformation initiatives across the enterprise
3. Understand how to structure experiments, pilots and prototypes to learn and iterate quickly
4. Evaluate the leadership capabilities and organizational conditions required for sustained innovation

Competencies:

1. Recognize where AI can generate new business models, offerings and value streams
2. Lead or contribute to innovation teams that design AI-enhanced solutions and services
3. Translate experimental learning into scalable transformation initiatives
4. Communicate the strategic rationale and long-term vision for AI innovation
5. Align innovation efforts with business strategy, stakeholder value and organizational readiness

Guiding Questions:

1. How can AI be used to drive transformation?
2. Where are the overlooked opportunities to use AI in service design, product development or customer experience?
3. What mindsets and capabilities are required to lead innovation in an AI-powered organization?
4. How do we design pilots that are ambitious enough to matter but realistic enough to execute?
5. What structures support continuous innovation with AI while managing complexity and risk?
6. How do we integrate transformation initiatives into existing business models without fragmentation?
7. What does it take to move from experimentation to scale in AI-enhanced environments?
8. How can students build coalitions that support AI innovation across functional silos?
9. What are the risks of using AI to innovate without clear alignment to purpose or value?
10. How can organizations evolve their leadership models to support AI-based transformation?
11. What frameworks or tools help prioritize innovation opportunities and measure their impact?
12. How can students position themselves to lead or influence innovation initiatives in their companies?

Class Topics and Schedule

Refer to the class schedule in the program website and dashboard for specific meeting dates and times. Activity and assignment details will be explained in detail within each week's corresponding learning module.

If you have any questions concerning the Certificate Program, please contact Danielle LaPage at danielle@hackinghr.io.

Wednesdays | 8:00–10:00 a.m. Pacific Time

- **Week 1**
  Program Orientation and Class 1: *Strategic Leadership in the Age of AI: Unlocking Business Competitive Advantage with AI-Powered Human Intelligence*
- **Week 2**
  Class 2: *Translating AI Strategy into Execution and Workplace Ecosystem Redesign: Cross-Functional Integration at Scale*
- **Week 3**
  Class 3: *Developing Organizational AI Readiness Through AI Fluency, Technical Capability, Culture and Collaboration*
- **Week 4**
  Class 4: *Establishing Ethical, Data Privacy, Accountable and Compliant AI Governance Frameworks*
- **Week 5**
  Final Assignment and Class 5: *Harnessing AI for Enterprise-Wide Innovation and Strategic Transformation*